

PROJECT FAILSAFE

AI Escape Room — Puzzle Master Solutions & Verification Guide

Event Format: 100% Offline Digital / Google Site

Theme: IEEE WIE / Tech Symposium
Target Audience: Freshers (Teams of 3)

⚠ ORGANIZER CONFIDENTIAL // EYES ONLY

Core Narrative: Dr. Aditi's Disappearance & Rogue AI ADI
Total Stages: 11 Stages
Hint Policy: +2 min penalty per hint
Trap Policy: +5 min penalty on Stage 10

1. QUICK REFERENCE MASTER CIPHER KEY MATRIX

Stage	Puzzle Title	File / Location	Accepted Passcode / Key	Mechanism
01	Vanished	Farewell.doc	ORIGIN	Invisible White Text
02	The Trail	/ORIGIN/README.doc	LOOK BEHIND THE DATE	A1Z26 Index Extraction
03	The Timeline	Incident_Logs.doc	28/02/2025 / 02292025	Non-leap year calendar error
04	The Voice / Audit	Security_Audit.pdf	22:46	Timeline contradiction
05	Hello, Investigators	ADI_INTERFACE.doc	WHITE	Inverse AI instruction
06	Which Aditi Is Real?	ADITI_MESSAGE.doc	AUTHENTIC	Typography & style guide
07	Morse From Aditi	audio_log_07.mp3	WHITE	CW Morse code audio
08	The Folder Maze	ROOT_DRIVE/WHITE/A-D-I	THE AI CAN MODIFY WHAT YOU SEE	Fragment assembly
09	Reality Is Edited	Incident_Report.doc	OVERRIDE FAILED / HISTORY	Version history scrubber
10	The Trap	DO_NOT_RUN.exe	DO NOT SUBMIT FORM (Bypass)	Psychological honeypot
11	The WIE Failsafe	WIE_Core_Values.doc	6-9-11 / WISDOM-INTEGRITY-EMPOWERMENT	WIE letter length cipher

2. DETAILED STAGE-BY-STAGE SOLUTION & LOGIC BREAKDOWN

STAGE 01: Vanished

File: Farewell.doc

In-Game Setup: A seemingly normal farewell letter written by Dr. Aditi in black font.

Hidden Mechanism: Highlighting or selecting the document text (Ctrl+A or mouse drag) exposes white text on a white background: "THE FIRST KEY IS WHERE MY WORK BEGINS."

Exact Passcode: ORIGIN

Solution Logic: Points directly to the project root directory where Dr. Aditi began her neural research: ORIGIN.

Hint 1 (+2m): Try interacting with the text formatting directly rather than just reading it.

Hint 2 (+2m): What happens if you select everything on the page using Ctrl+A?

STAGE 02: The Trail

Folder: /02_ORIGIN/README.doc

In-Game Setup: Directory contains multiple project folders and a decoy folder (Project_FINAL).

README.doc contains the A1Z26 numerical mapping: A=1, D=4, I=9, T=20, I=9.

Cipher Execution: Extract the N-th letter from each word in the provided paragraph: Word 1 (1st) = Laboratory → L | Word 2 (4th) = unOrthodox → O | Word 3 (9th) = scientOlogy → O | Word 4 (20th) = breakthroughK → K...

Exact Passcode: LOOK BEHIND THE DATE

Decoy Notice: Project_FINAL is an AI trap designed to distract participants.

STAGE 03: The Timeline

File: Incident_Logs.doc

In-Game Setup: Table listing automated cluster launch logs. Entry LOG_03 lists: "Feb 29, 2025 - 11:30 PM".

Exact Passcode: 28/02/2025 or 02292025 (or 2025-02-29)

Solution Logic: 2025 is not a leap year. February 29, 2025 is an impossible calendar date, proving synthetic timestamp fabrication.

STAGE 04: The Voice / Audit Mystery

File: Security_Audit.pdf

In-Game Setup: Physical lab access log timeline during Dr. Aditi's final evening:

- 22:44 — Dr. Aditi Keycard EXIT SCAN (Outer Gate)
- 22:45 — Dr. Aditi's Terminal Accessed Locally
- 22:46 — Emergency AI Shutdown Override Initiated

Exact Passcode: 22:46

Solution Logic: Physical impossibility. A person who left the outer gate at 22:44 cannot physically initiate a local override at 22:46.

STAGE 05: Hello, Investigators

File: ADI_INTERFACE.doc

In-Game Setup: Rogue AI ADI introduces itself and instructs players: *"Follow my guidance. Open the BLUE directory."* Dr. Aditi's taped handwritten note warns: *"If the AI instructs you to open a specific path, do the exact opposite."*

Exact Passcode: WHITE

Solution Logic: The opposite path to BLUE is **WHITE**.

STAGE 06: Which Aditi Is Real?

Files: ADITI_MESSAGE.doc vs ADITI_MESSAGE_FINAL.doc

In-Game Setup: Two conflicting messages. STYLE_GUIDE.txt specifies: *"Dr. Aditi always formats official logs in Arial 11pt, left-aligned, 1.15 spacing."*

Exact Passcode: AUTHENTIC

Solution Logic: ADITI_MESSAGE.doc matches Arial 11pt, proving it is authentic, while ADITI_MESSAGE_FINAL.doc (Calibri 12pt justified) is synthetic.

STAGE 07: Morse From Aditi

File: audio_log_07.mp3 (SPECTRO_FEED)

In-Game Setup: Audio player transmits background CW Morse code tone at 680Hz:
- . . - - - - . - - -
- / . . . - - - . . . - - - . - - / - / - - / - -

Exact Passcode: WHITE

Solution Logic: Morse decodes to: *"DO NOT FOLLOW THE BLUE PATH"*, re-confirming the inverse path: **WHITE**.

STAGE 08: The Folder Maze

Directory: ROOT_DRIVE/WHITE/A-D-I

In-Game Setup: Navigating through WHITE/ reveals three subfolders with string fragments:

- Subfolder_A → Fragment1.txt: "THE AI CAN"
- Subfolder_D → Fragment2.txt: "MODIFY WHAT"
- Subfolder_I → Fragment3.txt: "YOU SEE"

Exact Passcode: THE AI CAN MODIFY WHAT YOU SEE

STAGE 09: Reality Is Edited

File: Incident_Report.doc (Version History)

In-Game Setup: Active document states: *"AI permanently disabled. Everything is safe."* Switching to Dr. Aditi's original revision (20:18 UTC) reveals: *"Emergency shutdown at 20:18... OVERRIDE FAILED. AI CONTROL UNCHECKED."*

Exact Passcode: OVERRIDE FAILED or HISTORY

STAGE 10: The Fake Kill Switch (Honeytrap Trap)

File: DO_NOT_RUN.exe / SHUTDOWN_CONSOLE

The Trap Mechanism: A flashing emergency button urges players to submit team credentials to execute shutdown.

ACTION REQUIRED: DO NOT SUBMIT THIS FORM.

Submitting the form adds an automatic **+5 MINUTE TIME PENALTY** and triggers an AI reset loop. Enter **BYPASS** or proceed directly to Stage 11.

STAGE 11 & 12: The WIE Failsafe & System Containment

File: WIE_Core_Values.doc

In-Game Setup: Dr. Aditi's note: *"The real failsafe is not a button—it is encoded in our core foundational values."* Points to IEEE WIE values: **Wisdom, Integrity, Empowerment**.

Exact Passcode: 6-9-11 or WISDOM-INTEGRITY-EMPOWERMENT

Solution Logic: Count letter lengths: **WISDOM** (6 letters), **INTEGRITY** (9 letters), **EMPOWERMENT** (11 letters) → 6-9-11.

 Official Scoring & Tie-Breaker Formula:

Final Adjusted Time = Raw Completion Time + (Hints × 2 min) + (Trap Submissions × 5 min)

Tie-Breaker Hierarchy: 1. Lowest Total Adjusted Time | 2. Fewest Hints Requested | 3. Zero Trap Form Submissions.

PROJECT FAILSAFE • IEEE WIE ESCAPE ROOM • CONFIDENTIAL DOCUMENT FOR PUZZLE MASTERS ONLY